

Kushal Badodekar

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SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 3+ years' experience securing enterprise networks and endpoints through incident response, advanced automation, and detection engineering. Skilled in triaging, resolving security incidents, and optimizing SIEM/EDR platforms (CrowdStrike, Splunk, Microsoft Defender). Proficient in threat hunting and driving vulnerability management to strengthen security posture. Recognized for critical thinking, proactive risk mitigation, and driving continuous improvement.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Cyber Forensics and Security - Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL, USA May 2025

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science - Visvesvaraya Technological University, Karnataka, India June 2019

SKILLS

Tools & Platforms: CrowdStrike Falcon, Splunk, Microsoft Defender, Tenable, Wireshark, AWS, Azure, Zscaler, YARA, ServiceNow

Technical Skills: Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Malware Analysis, Vulnerability Management, SOAR, IDS/IPS

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST-800, ISO27001, SOX, PCI-DSS, OWASP

Programming Languages: Python, Bash, SQL, PowerShell

WORK HISTORY

Security Analyst | *James Hardie Building Products – Chicago, USA (Internship)* June 2024 – Dec 2024

- Investigated and triaged **500+** security incidents (phishing, cloud anomalies, endpoint intrusions), leveraging **SIEM** and **EDR** to identify root causes, coordinate containment, and deliver incident reports.
- Enhanced **25+ EDR** correlation rules in **CrowdStrike Falcon** and **Defender**, cutting **MTTD** by **15%** for sophisticated threats.
- Tuned **15+ Splunk** SIEM rules mapped to **MITRE ATT&CK** reducing false positives by **20%** and boosting SOC productivity.
- Integrated **CASB** with **Splunk** to visualize cloud storage usage, driving data cleanup, saving over **\$120K** in annual cloud costs.
- Automated **20+ SOAR** workflows in **Python/PowerShell** for phishing, malware, and access events, cutting triage time by **25%**.
- Configured **Zscaler WAF** rules to block **80+** malicious domains, reducing inbound threat traffic by **15%** and strengthening web defenses.
- Maintained **security architecture** documentation to ensure **100% compliance**, and effective **risk management** controls.
- Achieved **95%** on-time remediation of critical vulnerabilities via **Tenable**-driven scans across **8,000+** assets.

Security Engineer | *ATOS (DLL) – India* April 2021 – Aug 2023

- Mentored a team of **10+** engineers, orchestrating **25+ tabletop** attack/defense exercises that accelerated **IR SLAs** by **30%**.
- Coordinated **full-lifecycle incident response** for **20+** major security incidents, partnering with **DevOps** and **IT** to remediate lateral movement, cloud misconfigurations, and insider threats.
- Executed **30+** targeted **threat hunting investigations** across **2,000+ endpoints** and multiple log sources using **IOC/IOA** analysis, uncovering **15+** undetected attack techniques.
- Developed **40+ IR playbooks** and **technical SOPs**, standardizing triage workflows and increasing **incident handling efficiency**.
- Managed **vulnerability scans** covering **10,000+ assets**, prioritized remediation using risk scores, and drove closure of **100%** of critical findings, ensuring **NIST/ISO** compliance.
- Reverse-engineered **15+ malware** samples extracting IOCs to reinforce detection logic and reduce missed threat events by **25%**.
- Deployed **Abnormal Security** custom **email detection** rules, reducing **phishing attacks** by **20%** and fortifying **email security**.
- Led configuration, deployment, and security operations of **Palo Alto** VPN services for a **5000+** global user base, sustaining **99.9% uptime** and achieving **zero security breaches**.

Cybersecurity Analyst | *ATOS (DLL) – India* Feb 2020 – March 2021

- Created **25+** custom **Splunk** correlation rules and detection dashboards, automating alerting for suspicious lateral movement and credential compromise behaviors, reducing **threat detection** time.
- Mitigated **100+** security incidents by analyzing **Win Event Logs & Sysmon telemetry**, reducing incident resolution time by **35%**.
- Remediated **15+** Azure Entra ID misconfigurations, eliminating privilege escalation risks and securing **10+** critical business apps.
- Hardened **Active Directory (AD)** security, implementing group policy restrictions, enforcing **least privilege** access, and monitoring login anomalies, reducing unauthorized access risks by **40%** and blocking **100+** unauthorized login attempts.
- Modernized **firewall policies** and optimized **Snort IDS/IPS** detection logic, boosting threat prevention effectiveness by **30%** and reducing false positives by **25%**.
- Launched phishing awareness campaigns using **KnowBe4**, reducing employee click rates by **25%**.

CERTIFICATIONS AND COMPETITIONS

Certifications:

- CompTIA Security+
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- SOC Detection Engineering - Antisyphon
- Practical Malware Analysis & Triage

Competitions:

- CyberTruck, CyberTractor 2025 – Penetration Testing
- Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition 2024 – 4th Place
- Cyber Force 2023 – 5th Place, CTF & Anomaly Detection
- NCAE Cyber Games – 1st Regionals & 3rd Nationals.

PROJECTS

Malware Analysis

- Conducted in-depth analysis and triage of real-world malware samples, identifying persistence, command-and-control, and evasion tactics used by advanced threats.
- Developed custom YARA detection rules and automated scripts, accelerating identification and response for emerging malware by 40%.

AI Security

- Performed adversarial testing to discover and mitigate vulnerabilities in AI/ML models (data poisoning, evasion, model inversion) using MITRE ATLAS and ART toolkit.
- Implemented defense strategies that improved AI model resilience and alignment with secure development standards, reducing exploitable attack vectors by 30%.

Active Directory Security

- Designed and deployed a domain controller lab, enabling enhanced logging and threat detection capabilities and reducing attack surface exposure.
- Simulated advanced attacks (Kerberoasting, LLMNR, relay) to identify security gaps and implement countermeasures, decreasing domain compromise risk and improving audit outcomes

Hardware Security

- Conducted firmware analysis and hardening on PLC/RTU devices; led red team engagements targeting OT protocols (Wireshark, J1939, Modbus, Ethernet/IP) within a segmented Purdue Model environment.
- Identified and remediated ICS vulnerabilities, strengthening operational resilience and ensuring regulatory compliance for industrial networks